Table 6.1 Valid values for the Access-Control-Allow-Origin header

Access-Control-Allow-Origin value	Effect on the response
`<no header>`	CORS isn't supported for any origins
`*`	CORS is supported for all origins
`null`	CORS is supported for unknown origins (such as accessing from a file rather than a website)
`<origin value>`	CORS is supported on a specific origin

6.3.1 Allowing cross-origin access for everyone

If you want to allow cross-origin requests to the widest audience, use the `*` value for the Access-Control-Allow-Origin header. The `*` value indicates that any client can make a cross-origin request to this resource.

An example of a site that sets the `*` value is the HTML5Rocks.com website. This website contains a wealth of articles and tutorials for using HTML5. HTML5Rocks.com sets the `Access-Control-Allow-Origin: *` header on every page. This allows other JavaScript developers to use CORS to consume and parse any page on the HTML5Rocks .com site.

The `*` value works best in the cases where

- The resource should be accessible to as wide a range of users as possible.
- You don't know ahead of time which origins and clients will access the resource.
- No authentication or individualization is required.

Turning to the sample code, it's easy to enable the `*` value on all pages, as shown in the following code:

```
var handleCors = function(options) {
  return function(req, res, next) {
    res.set('Access-Control-Allow-Origin', '*');
```

Note that just because the `*` value is enabled, it doesn't mean that the request will be successful. The request may fail for other reasons, such as a 404 Not Found or a 500 Internal Server Error. The `*` value only indicates that a client can make cross-origin requests, and nothing more.

BE CAREFUL WITH CONTENT BEHIND A FIREWALL

Setting the `*` value comes with a caveat: you should be careful when setting it on content behind a firewall. A firewall is set up specifically to allow access to a certain set of users. For example, your company may maintain a firewall so that only employees can access certain pages on the intranet. The `*` value can be used to bypass these restrictions and broadcast the data to unintended users.

Figure 6.1 illustrates the dangers of allowing all origins over a VPN. Suppose there are some private internal documents on your company's intranet, which happens to have the `Access-Control-Allow-Origin: *` header set. As an employee, because you're